

KF Mini-Meeting Lesson 36

--"MINI-MEETING" FORMAT-- (20 min)

I - MINDFULNESS (4 min)

-ANB (1 min)

-3 Minute Breathing Space (3 min)

II - CHECK-IN (10 min)

-KF Member "A" shares (5 min)

(1) What I learned

(2) Signs of MO

(3) Signs of Orientation

(4) Five things I am thankful for

-KF Member "B" shares (5 min)

(1) What I learned

(2) Signs of MO

(3) Signs of Orientation

(4) Five things I am thankful for

III - KF MEETING "REVIEW" (6 min)

-Bible Teaching -- selected excerpt of previous week KF Bible teaching (5 min)

-Ending Prayer (1 min)

BIBLE TEACHING

Turn in your Bibles to the book of Hebrews, which falls right before James. We will read **Hebrews 12:1– 17** in Nancy's paraphrase, which builds on ideas from chapter 11.

Hebrews 12:1-17

¹When we consider all those who have gone before us into a better country—who acted on their beliefs and who already know by experience what we are coming to know—we are encouraged to keep moving toward that country set aside for us by God. Therefore, lay aside the heavy weight of the Idol Self and its misorientation, which so easily entangles us. Let us run with endurance the challenge stretching out before us and ²fix our sights on the beacon light of Jesus, who by the example of His choices leads us forward. He accomplished the goal of showing us the way home. He endured the cross and exchanged it for joy. He resisted self-hate and took His place of authority next to the throne of God. That is your path, too. ³Let's think about that. He, our Lord and leader, endured the same kinds of misoriented people that you endure, people who resist the person of Jesus in their thoughts and choices. His example encourages us not to abandon our Idol Self or become weary in our efforts.

⁴Let's get real. You can still do better in your striving against misorientation. Your efforts haven't killed you yet! ⁵You have forgotten the firm guidance that is addressed to you as sons: "My son, do not undervalue the discipline of God, believing that it should be light and easy, and do not faint when He corrects you, believing that His correction and discipline are too hard and unfair. ⁶Why do we engage with His training? Because God only disciplines those whom He loves, and every son that He receives as a candidate for training He thoroughly corrects." ⁷You endure in order to be trained. In other words, your training requires your endurance. God is dealing with you as He would deal with sons. Think about this: What kind of father would not train his own son? ⁸Training is something that everyone experiences. If you are not trained by God, then you are not of God's lineage—you are not His son. ⁹Before we were accepted as sons of God, we were trained by fathers of our material lineage, and we turned toward their way of doing things, which did not help us much. We would do better to come under the management of the Father of our spiritual lineage, and live. ¹⁰Let me explain what I mean. Our material fathers trained us for a short time according to what they thought was best, but not according to what we needed. God, however, trains us according to what would benefit us now and profit us in the better country that He has set apart for us. ¹¹For all training seems grievous and difficult rather than fun. But if we make our training an exercise in orientation, it will eventually reward us with the fruit of peace. ¹²That being the case, straighten up the hands that have given up out of exhaustion and the knees that are wobbling from effort. ¹³Stop wasting your energy in bad training that causes exhaustion and wobbling. Get going in the right direction so that you can heal your ability to work and to run.

¹⁴Pursue peace with everyone and work toward achieving a life set apart in orientation and truth. No one will be able to see the Lord in you if you do not achieve that kind of life. ¹⁵Keep a watch on yourselves and see that no one dawdles behind in their relationship with God. Make sure that no one allows a root of bitterness to sprout up where relationship should be sprouting up; bitter roots cause trouble and defile many. ¹⁶Watch over yourselves and see that no sexually untrustworthy persons dwell among you— people who allow themselves to be trodden on by cravings and defilement. Esau was a person like that. He exchanged his precious first-born rights for simple food, just because he could not endure a little discomfort. ¹⁷You know how this turned out. Even afterwards, when Esau wished to inherit favor and the blessing, he was rejected as a candidate because he had shown himself unworthy to be a son. As an untrustworthy person, he had refused the relationship training. He could not undo the damage he had done, even though he sought to do so with tears, because tears are not a substitute for trustworthy action.

Take a deep breath.

This passage is rich in ideas, and you might explore some of them for yourself. Here's what Nancy would like you to remember.

1. We all have a race to run

That contest is different for each of us, but the goal is the same, to develop the character of Jesus.

2. We endure tough things because we have a goal

We are in training for our mission and for our joy, and to bring joy to God. We are becoming a holy place in a very unholy world. Our training might feel severe for a time, but that is only our perception and not the reality, for we know that the burden of Jesus is easy, and His yoke is light. One of the benefits of training is the discovery of how weak we actually are; we discover how much our misorientation is interfering with our efforts to run with endurance.

3. We can choose to strengthen our souls for the contest

Don't dawdle at the starting post out of laziness or the fear of suffering, nor give up at the first discouraging hurdle. Your race is the opportunity that you need to build up your soul. Every hurdle has the potential to increase your joy. Productive suffering turning to joy is one of the cycles of life.

We have no reason to fear our training. God's training takes us on a journey to a better country. Let's listen to Nancy's paraphrase of Jude's description of God our Trainer:

Jude 24

²⁴To Him who, like a watchful parent, has the power to help you avoid falls and, also, to keep you on your feet as you stand before His glory without blemish and with great joy— ²⁵to the only God our Savior, through Jesus Christ our Lord, be glory, majesty, government, and authority before all the ages, now, and throughout all generations.

Our prayer might go something like this:

Heavenly Parent, teach me to courageously run with endurance my own contest. (Repeat)

Take a deep breath.

ENDING PRAYER

Dear Father and Creator,

Thank You for drawing us together as we present ourselves to You for training. Hold us in the power of this orientation and continue to guide us to our glory and truth. Prepare the next step in our healing this week as we co-labor with You to reorient our lives for a more effective flow and to flourish in our connection with our True Design and mission, with our community and the rest of Creation, and with You, for the glory and honor of our Lord Jesus. Amen.